Rep. Tom Emmer on Man vs. Machine: Week 10

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ADAM LEVITAN:

Hello and welcome to a Week 10 edition of Man vs Machine InSeason. My name is Adam Levitan. Each and every Thursday this season we are gathered to embrace debate around a fistful of the most important topics of the week. This show is for InSeason subscribers only. Truly, really do appreciate you all being subs. Hope and trust that you are getting value out of your subscription this season. Joining me, Man vs Machine, as always, the man himself, Evan Silva. How are you?

EVAN SILVA:

Good. I'm excited to try to guess Leone's jersey.

ADAM LEVITAN:

Yes. And the machine, Michael Leone, looks like a number 30 Bengals, which of course is currently Chase Brown. However, however, that is not Chase Brown, is it Icky Woods, Leone?

MICHAEL LEONE:

Right away. Right away. Icky Woods. Icky shuffle, baby.

ADAM LEVITAN:

Yeah. That is a great jersey, the Icky Shuffle. How did they not retire that number and give it to Chase Brown, this bum?

MICHAEL LEONE:

It's crazy. I remember Icky Woods so much from watching NFL films as a kid. That's like half the reason I get the jerseys I do, and he had one good season as a rookie. That was back when if you blew out your knee, you were kind of like, you know, good game, and I think he blew out his knee in his second year and could never really make it back. But he had such a huge impact, and they went to the Super Bowl his rookie season.

EVAN SILVA:

I thought he got big into the booger sugar.

MICHAEL LEONE:

I can't speak to those allegations. I only wear the jerseys. If that's false, I just want to apologize.

ADAM LEVITAN:

I've never heard that before, the booger sugar. Okay. Anyways, let's get into it here today. We have a bunch of topics to get to. I know we've talked about this Kirk Cousins thing a few times on a bunch of different shows. I just think it's so important that I want to go over it one more time. And I guess the question I want to pose to

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you, Leonie, is Sylve and I have called Kevin O'Connell a quarterback whisperer. I've talked relentlessly about how it's really hard to fail in this scheme with Kevin O'Connell. You're playing the Dome. You have Justin Jefferson. And yet the last three guys that I have been optimistic on in this spot, I'm talking JJ McCarthy last year. I'm talking Kyler Murray this year, and I'm talking Carson Wentz on Monday night against the Bills. I just look stupid because all three of those quarterbacks have drastically underperformed what I thought. So I want to be high here on Kirk Cousins resurrecting this thing, but I'm striking out left and right being high on Vikings quarterback plays. So with that as the context, Leonie, what is your take on how much of an impact this Kirk Cousins thing is going to have?

MICHAEL LEONE:

Yeah. I mean, I was stunned how bad Carson Wentz was Monday night, just watching this Bills defense all season long. They get a home game. They kept being in advantageous positions. It was pretty shocking to me. And as far as the KOC, QB Whisperer stuff, I wonder if we just hold on sometimes to these coaches too long or maybe give them too much credit. I know the Mike McDaniel Chargers stuff too has been such a nightmare, and it's possible that we undervalued some of the quarterback's talent that he played with, Cousins himself and Sam Darnold. With that said, I'm pretty optimistic that the floor on Justin Jefferson immediately comes up much higher. That was a huge concern. If you look at past attempts per offensive play, over the past four seasons for Minnesota, 64% of offensive plays resulted in a past attempt when they had Kirk Cousins at quarterback, only 52% for all other quarterbacks. Now, I don't expect it to be that high because the defense is so good this year and doesn't show any signs of slowing down, but I think the reception volume for everybody should just kind of raise the floors, and I'm excited to see what Jefferson can do the rest of the way.

ADAM LEVITAN:

To complement your point, Leone, a lot of the idea that Kevin O'Connell was a quarterback whisperer was built on quarterbacks having really high volume as passers when they'd be coached by Kevin O'Connell, and that goes to Kirk Cousins, although Kirk Cousins has always been a good quarterback. When Josh Dobbs went in the game, he was good in fantasy. He wasn't actually good in real life. When Nick Mullins goes in the game and throws for 400 yards, although I think in that game he threw four interceptions too, a lot of that is just built on pass volume period and having excellent pass catchers to take advantage of that with. I think that in this scenario now, because of how good the Vikings defense is, I don't know that we're going to see big-time fireworks. Dude, in 2022, if you go back to that season, Justin Jefferson was the best receiver in the NFL. He led the NFL in targets, receptions, and receiving yards. He was the overall fantasy wide receiver one. Jordan Addison, that was Jordan Addison's rookie year was in 2023, the following year with Kirk Cousins, before he tore his Achilles, Jordan Addison was going off. He had seven touchdowns in eight games with Kirk Cousins before he got hurt. And TJ Hawkinson, over the course of 19 games, including playoffs with Kirk Cousins, 126 catches. It's just, I don't think that we're going to see that same kind of volume that the Vikings were playing with in 2022 and 2023 because of how good the defense is.

MICHAEL LEONE:

Yeah, I think that's well said for sure. Two more points on this, you know, Leonie, I know we look at the pass rate over expectation stuff a lot. It surprised me a little bit that over the last four weeks, despite the quarterback play, Vikings have still been positive pass rate over expectation. Now with Cousins, that just makes me think like Kevin O'Connor wants to throw at all costs. It also suggests that their run game has been somewhat broken, which I think is fair. But could we see the pass rate really spike? How high do you think that they could get in their pass rate here, Leonie, at a team level? Obviously, the Bengals have been absolutely off the charts lately, but Vikings are, you know, whatever. Plus two, that's pretty strong. Can they get higher?

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ADAM LEVITAN:

I think you're on mute, Leonie.

MICHAEL LEONE:

Just realizing that I had myself on mute. I don't think they're going to get much higher than plus 2%. You know, I could be wrong, but I still, with the way this defense is, I would expect them to stay around that point. So you're talking about a low 60s drop back rate, maybe high 50s, kind of depending on how strong the defense is. So I'm a little bit worried about the overall volume, but I still think the amount of plays that turn into, you know, a catchable target in particular, we were just looking at pass attempts for offensive play, you know, the disparity is even wider if you catchable targets, you know, per drop back is just going to be so much higher with Kirk Cousins. I do think they have some incentive, certainly, to keep Justin Jefferson healthy. Like obviously goal number one is to win football games, but goal number two is to keep your alpha star wide receiver somewhat, you know, content.

ADAM LEVITAN:

Yeah. Justin Jefferson is currently our top value on DraftKings. His price is 6,800, obviously lagging behind on the lack of volume. They don't have the quarterback change in there. Given the pricing, we'll get to that in a minute, we could see Justin Jefferson as maybe the highest owned wide receiver on the slate. I know you haven't gone over the Sims and everything, Leone, but any initial thought on JJF being the most owned wide receiver on this slate?

MICHAEL LEONE:

Yeah, I think everyone's going to want to play him. First game with Cousins back, you get an opponent too that even though you don't get the game in a dome because you're in Green Bay, you get an opponent that can put up points against this defense that should force that pass rate for Minnesota. I think everybody's concerned about the volume, but this is a spot where actually you've got good reason to expect it to be higher than normal. I think he's going to be very, very heavily played between the pricing, the projection, and just the narrative around everything.

ADAM LEVITAN:

Yeah. And I don't want to forget about Addison too, I mean, and Hockinson, you know, Silva talked about it too. I mean, those guys get big, big bumps as well from a floor perspective at a minimum. All right. Let's go to Jordan Tyson. Silva and I talked about this on Tuesday, you know, really strong debut. The usage was not great, but in terms of the targets that he earned on the routes that he ran, I thought it was awesome. And then if you watch the cut up, and if you guys want to see it, I quote tweeted, somebody did a really good cut up of all of Jordan Tyson's routes. I mean, this dude is just open on every play. I'm not exaggerating. He's like open on every single play. Now, it's hard to project exactly how much more he's going to play this week. Silva, what do you think about Jordan Tyson this week and rest of season?

EVAN SILVA:

I'm still taking a pretty cautious approach on him. The thing that scares me about that is that I love this game. I took the over on 48 and a half. I think that both sides can cook from a passing game standpoint. So you know, Jordan Tyson was at 35% last week of on field participation, five targets, you know, if they get him up to like 55%, he could be a factor in fantasy.

ADAM LEVITAN:

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Yeah. I mean, that's how good he is. And that's how good this game environment is, I think. Yeah. And Tyler Schalke is going to be one of the most popular quarterbacks this week. I'm more curious long term what you think about Tyson here, Leone. They have a very, very good fantasy playoff schedule. I don't think we can really play him at 5k here in this game. Maybe we can, but that would be, I think, a bit thin given the usage we saw last week. And then the rest of season for season long, people, I think it's really interesting. I've been stashing him even in a 10 team league. I've been stashing Jordan Tyson to try to see how it goes late season, Leone. Any rest of season thoughts on Jordan Tyson?

MICHAEL LEONE:

I'm really bullish here. And it's one of those things where it's maybe not so much very high degree of confidence that it's going to work out. Just that if it does work out as the potential to be kind of like this league winning player down the stretch, and there's just at this point in this season, there's generally not a lot of spots for that type of uncertainty where you can really profit disproportionately. So in redraft, if you're still able to make moves, I would pretty aggressively try to get Tyson. I think the targets per out run, you mentioned him getting open was a really positive sign the first week, even though the ADOT was super low. And Kellen Moore talked about getting the volume up moving forward and how it'll be more normal moving forward, which clearly indicates that the route share was just down for a first game back and they want to make sure he's healthy. This was a prospect that kind of ticked a ton of boxes analytically. I know, I think Jack on his bold calls prior in the off season had him like performing in line with Chris Alave. It's the absolute perfect spot too. I like when you have a really talented wide receiver one, but no clear wide receiver two and a pass heavy offense. I think that's the perfect sort of spot for someone like Tyson to come in where he can have enough volume to be successful and the efficiency really should swing his way as well. So I'm pretty optimistic here the rest of the season.

ADAM LEVITAN:

Yeah, really, really strong late season schedule. That's really why I've been stashing Tyson is for those week 15, 16, 17. If he hits, those are gonna be awesome, awesome spots. We'll talk plenty more about the New Orleans Carolina game tomorrow night and Leone on Saturday as well, because this is a very, very important game for DFS this week. Let's go to, oh God, I'm like, I'm almost tired of talking about Chase Brown, but it is relentless that the Chase Brown discord, thankfully this is the Sunday night game. So it is not part of main slate. You know, the sentiment on Chase Brown has gotten really, really low. I just wonder how different the sentiment would be on Chase Brown if he had converted his chance from the one yard line instead of getting stuffed. And then the next play they do a Joe Burrow quarterback sneak and he gets in. So I know Leone has been labeled a Chase Brown hater. I feel like now he's on the other side. He's defending Chase Brown and Chase Brown does show up on the by Leone this week here as well, Leone.

MICHAEL LEONE:

Yeah, I do think the hate maybe has gone too far. Obviously from a rush efficiency standpoint, it's been a disappointing season at 3.9 yards per carry, but you know, had a couple back to back games with strong efficiency over four and a half yards per carry. I know the usage in the final box score doesn't look great last week. The Bengals have been super high pass rate of expectation though. And late in the game, P Ryan had seven carries the last two drives compared to two for Chase Brown. So him out carrying Chase Brown, I think is a little of a bit of a red herring there. Overall, you know, it's not the split that you want for Chase Brown, but it's certainly more than enough, especially in PPR leagues to pay off in a big way. He's already got, you know, games with eight targets, 11 targets that doesn't grow on trees by any means. If you look at the carries inside the 10 inside the five this season, it is like two to one in favor of Chase Brown. The bottom line is he's run really bad on touchdown scoring. And we have him actually in one of our tools that looks at touchdown over and

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under performers as the second biggest under performer relative to expected touchdowns on the entire season schedule is really favorable for Bengals moving forward. You know, I still don't think he has, you know, the ceiling to be one of those elite round one guys, but I expect him to be a back end RB one and definitely an RB to rest away, which I know probably doesn't feel that way given the way the actual scoring has gone thus far.

ADAM LEVITAN:

I mean, they've thrown for so many touchdowns more than they should versus rushing, even with a really high pass rate over expectation. They just have not. Samajit Piran has one touchdown. Chase Brown has one touchdown. Joe Burrow has thrown for 23. Like that kind of stuff is unsustainable, right, Leone?

MICHAEL LEONE:

It's a little bit unsustainable, but even so, I mean, Chase Brown caught five touchdowns last year. He caught four touchdowns the year before that. He has zero receiving touchdowns this year. So he should still score more. No matter what happens, he should be scoring more touchdowns is kind of the gist of it.

ADAM LEVITAN:

Right. And I do think this game is going like I think both teams going to want to throw in this game. I know you're not writing this game up, Silva, but my thought on this game was Bengals obviously want to throw a ton. Steelers have shown a willingness to throw a ton here also, and they may need to to keep up here. So I thought this could be like a really throw heavy game, which is fine for Chase Brown, you know, maybe even good for Chase Brown at times. It's good when he catches a lot of passes. I mean, no one wants to hear it that has been suffering through the Chase Brown experience for going on 10 weeks now. But the guys had a lot of bad luck this season. I mean, it's been a really hard luck season for Chase Brown, and that happens sometimes in a small sample sport. I think that he's a buy. If you can still make trades in your league, I think that Chase Brown is a buy for the stretch run. There's no way that he can continue to run this bad. We knew that regression was going to hit him this year. We knew that, as Leonie pointed out, five receiving touchdowns last year. That's not going to repeat. That was never going to repeat. But to repeat to this extent, I mean, now he's on the positive side of the mean regression. You know, he got hit in the, he got smacked in the mouth with it for the first nine weeks. Now he's set up for positive regression when it comes to touchdown scoring. I think he's a buy, like a clear cut buy. Okay. I want to go to the DFS slate this week, Leonie. You know, we've had a few of these slates this year, and this one may not be quite as bad as some of the ones that we've seen before, but it's the kind of slate where, at least as of now, all the best plays are also expensive plays. Bijon, CMC, JSN, James Cook, Alave. You know, Jefferson is okay. You know, 6,800 is fine. We've had slates that I guess have been worse, where like all the best plays were 8K or more. But Leonie, how do you think about these slates when, at least as of now, there is not a lot of value to be had?

MICHAEL LEONE:

So from a tournament perspective, I really love these slates because I feel like when the value plays are projecting really well in chalk, it's hard to get away from them. It's a little bit more difficult for me to find, you know, the best contrarian angles in GPPs. I feel like in these types of slates, it's a little bit easier. One move is just flipping the roster construction, where when the very expensive plays are the top values, you do have a, it seems backwards, but you actually have like a little bit more leeway on their performances because they're so expensive that they can, you know, Christian McCaffrey can hit his projection and have it not matter, you know, in tournaments. And you can run into some mid-tier running back plays and play these balanced lineups with the ceiling across the board that don't actually sacrifice a ton from a projection standpoint and get you a lot more leverage. So I like to play it that way. The other way, of course, is to jam in the studs and then just

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differentiate with the cheap guys that you're playing around it. I know the way DraftKings has priced the wide receiver position this year, those cheap wide receivers have been tough to find and to rely on. We had three chalk cheap wide receivers last week. I don't even know if they combined for 10 points total. So it's a very fragile spot. It's a good spot to get different. So I do enjoy these slates from a tournament perspective, and I probably lean a bit more on the flipping the roster construction build side of the ways to get different.

ADAM LEVITAN:

Yeah. I mean, you can see it in Solver, too. When you make a really balanced lineup, typically the projected ceiling is higher than the stars and scrubs lineup, right? Because let's say you can find a way for all these 6k, 5k, low 7k guys to find their ceiling at one time. Well, that's how you win a tournament, even if a 3k guy hits the ceiling. That's often like 12 points or something. Yeah, I think balanced is really an interesting way to go this week. I haven't started really trying to make teams yet, but yeah, certainly on my mind. In terms of specifics on this week, the one thing that I wanted to ask about, Silva, was this Texans defense. Can you explain what is going on with this unit? Do you think that it will turn around? I think it's at least notable here for this week. If you want to try to find some type of value, Concepcion is down here at 4,800, Denzel Boston is 5,200, and then you have this whole game set up, which is not going to look great. But yeah, Silva, what do you think about Houston's defense? Can they keep up? Can they turn it around here? Because they have so much talent and they've been so successful in the past, and they have had good games this year, I keep thinking I still don't want to bet against them.

EVAN SILVA:

They've given up a lot of explosive plays. Reid Blankenship, who they signed from the Eagles, has been terrible at safety. Kamari Lassiter, their number two cornerback, has taken a huge step back from really being one of the best cornerbacks in the league last year. Last year, they had one of the best cornerback tandems in the NFL. This year, they have one stud cornerback and one guy who's a huge liability, and teams can just throw on Kamari Lassiter. Kamari Lassiter is not fast either. He ran 4-6 coming out, and he's going to be vulnerable to explosive plays. Will Anderson has had a great year. Daniil Hunter has not. The pass rush has not been as consistent, just coming after you every single snap in the past. That also will contribute to allowing explosive plays. I think that's how I would sum it up, why it has happened. But I continue to think that, especially against the frickin' Browns, this is a game where the Texans could tee off and get seven sacks with Deshaun Watson back on their center.

ADAM LEVITAN:

I remember now why I wanted to flag this one for this show. It's because I just can't get over the volume that C.J. Stroud has had. Part of it is what Silva talked about, how the defense has been underperforming. If the defense has been dominant, like the Vikings defense or like the Texans defense has been before, we might not be seeing this type of volume from C.J. Stroud. So I was like, man, I think it's really interesting to play Texan stuff. I have not played enough Stroud stuff this year, but if their defense is going to be dominant against Cleveland, I don't really want to play it. So yeah, Leone, any thoughts on how it's gone for Houston this year, which has been very different than the way that I thought it would go?

MICHAEL LEONE:

Yeah, different for me as well. I think though they are finding, you know, it's a little bit of a perfect storm with the defense underperforming, but Stroud also getting back to that rookie year form and playing really, really well. Now Tank Dell's back and playing well. You know, it was great to see him score last week and they continue to not be able to run the ball. And that leads to sometimes a higher expected pass rate than you would think just

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based on the script, because you end in second and long, you know, you end up in these spots where your pass rate expectation is a little bit higher because you just can't run the ball. But in addition to that, they are a little bit handing the keys over to Stroud more than they've been willing to in the past as this, as he continues to play well in the run game, continues to be inefficient. They were plus nine points in pass rate of expectation last week. A couple of weeks before that, they were very negative, but on this season, they've now had five out of eight games where they've been top 10 in pass rate over expectation on the week. Three games where they've been top five on the week in pass rate over expectations. So I do think that that's really good for CJ Stroud owners, that he's going to be able to get there and still flash a ceiling, even in some of these games where the defense plays better.

ADAM LEVITAN:

I talked to someone with the Texans about Nico Collins. Now this person is not involved in like game planning or, you know, making the decisions on game day, but he thinks that the Texans are going to continue to use Nico Collins not as like a true featured receiver and that they want to spread the ball around. They've had Nico Collins on a weekly basis, 71% of the snaps, and it's really never gotten a whole lot higher than that because they want to try to keep him healthy. They think that Nico Collins has like legit soft tissue stuff and they want to limit his snaps and not feed him 14 targets a game because they think that this is a means of keeping him healthy. And they got all these other guys they can use even after losing Jalen Noel, they can still use, you know, for, and they love Xavier Hutchinson.

EVAN SILVA:

Yeah. Nick Caley and D'Amico Ryans love Xavier Hutchinson. That is not going to stop.

ADAM LEVITAN:

Someone said something about the, or I saw some quote, was that from Stroud who said that Xavier Hutchinson is the backbone of our offense?

EVAN SILVA:

Yeah, like the engine or something.

ADAM LEVITAN:

Dude, they love Xavier Hutchinson and there's no getting away from that. So we just have to accept that and move on. He's going to be playing 60% of the snaps every week. All right. One thing you were talking about the Texans defense. We'll see if this changes by, you know, Saturday, Sunday when we're doing content and stuff. But right now we have them as the highest projected own defense on this slate. I'm definitely going to personally bump up this Rams defense going against a first time starter, Myles Garrett back playing well. I think there's a chance we're under projecting them. And you know, it's something that's obvious that maybe the market comes around to as well. But with them being $400 more expensive, a lot of times those small pricing differences will just be like everybody just clicking Texans instead.

MICHAEL LEONE:

Definitely.

ADAM LEVITAN:

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Okay. Last thing from the DFS main slate, Silva, is this Ram situation. I mean, and we got positive news on Devante Adams. Sounds like maybe he'll be back in week 12, week 13, something like that. In the meantime, though, we know they're going to be extremely run heavy. They're going to try to play defense like Leone just said. But God, look at who they're throwing to. I mean, how can we not have big projection on Parkinson and Higby here? So Silva, any thoughts on how the Rams play offense this week at Arizona?

EVAN SILVA:

Well, number one, I think that there are scenarios where Stafford drops back to pass only like 24 times in the game. Yeah. I think that that's how the Rams would like to play. And I think that they theoretically should be able to against Arizona and just lean on their defense and their running game. They had two really good backs. They're very efficient as a running team. And the Cardinals, I think, are going to be without Roy Lopez, their run-stopping nose tackle, who was carted off with a toe injury last week. That'll be something I'll be looking at on Friday. But I don't think that he's going to play. So that's a boost to the Rams' rushing outlook. I don't know. You know, I think that the favorite is Kanata Mumfield. But some people in the Rams organization have talked up C.J. Daniels, a six-round pick. I remember this kid last year playing against Notre Dame in the first game. I think he was a pretty good player. People have been talking him up. I don't think it's a guarantee that it's going to be Mumfield in the puka role. I don't think that that's guaranteed. I think Kanata Mumfield stinks. And I think that it could maybe be a rotational situation, or they play four tight ends instead of even having a puka role.

ADAM LEVITAN:

Yeah, I don't think you can put any of these guys in the quote-unquote puka role. Leone, I know this is a very uncertain situation here. How do you think about Rams without both Devante and puka this week?

MICHAEL LEONE:

I mean, I'm with Silva a little bit in terms of I could see this pass rate being really, really low. You try not to be overconfident. The spread is what it is, but it's just hard for me to see Arizona moving the ball effectively with the quarterback and wide receiver injuries that they've suffered, and obviously trading Jacoby Brissett and against this Rams defense that's playing better, especially with Myles Garrett back. And with the injuries to the wide receiver position on the Rams side and how well they've run the ball, I feel like it's going to be a really rush-heavy attack. I wouldn't be surprised if people talk themselves into both Kyron and especially Blake Corham in tournaments. Kyron's the guy to me that's almost more interesting because I almost think people might end up playing Corham based on the recent performances a little bit more and with the reduced salary. Feeling more comfortable doing that than paying up for Kyron, but we'll see there. And it is crazy that we have puka and Devante Adams out, and none of these wide receivers are sniffing cash game lineups. It's a pretty unique situation in terms of the wide receiver rotation and the very heavy tight end formations that we're going to see out of the Rams. And the result is we're going to see a ton of Colby Parkinson chalk in tournaments because he's 3K, and I suspect him and Higby are going to be out there a ton and probably the safest two bets to lead the team in target share.

ADAM LEVITAN:

Yeah. I mean, as always, that tight end, like paying up, like yeah, maybe some people pay up for Tyler Warren. I don't think people are excited to click that. 3K for Colby Parkinson is going to look really, really good. Okay. Tonight's game is Giants-Commanders. I've struggled with Jaden Daniels, man, because his rookie year was so absurdly impressive. I guess, Silva, do you think we've seen the best of Jaden Daniels in his career as a rookie? I hate to be so dramatic, but we really have not seen him play well since his rookie year. Do you think we've seen the best of him, or is there more here for Jaden Daniels to ascend to?

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EVAN SILVA:

I mean, he's had a couple of really nice games this year. It's just, it has been really, really inconsistent. I mean, I blame the supporting cast. I mean, they lost Larry Mutonsel before the season. The writing was on the wall that they were going to have protection issues. Jaden Daniels suffers a second elbow dislocation. You know, they lose McLaurin. He had a 300-plus yard game against San Francisco, and he had that monster rushing game against the Giants earlier in the season. I mean, I think that he's got it. I think that he's not in a positive environment right now from a supporting cast standpoint.

ADAM LEVITAN:

Yeah, he will be the most known player on the slate tonight, almost certainly, because he's $1,000 less than Malik Neighbors on this showdown slate. Leone, any thoughts on Jaden Daniels, or any other thoughts on tonight's game?

MICHAEL LEONE:

Yeah, I mean, talk about if we've seen the best of him. It is funny how a couple times, you know, I just think through the discourse around him versus Caleb Williams after year one, and like how quickly this stuff can change. And even like Josh Allen's draft class, like year one, it was like clearly Baker. And then Lamar was clearly the best. And then it was clearly Josh Allen. And Darnold was the biggest bust ever. And it's just crazy how sharply this stuff changes. But as far as a fantasy value, this team is clearly not running him to the extent that he was in the past. If you look at his design carry share by season, 2024, it was 15%. 2025, it was 10%. This season, it's down to 4%. So that's a huge difference. If you look at his carries inside the 10, he had 13 carries inside the 10. In 2024, he scored five touchdowns on those 10 carries. This season, he has just one carry inside the 10. So the rushing from him is more... I want to say Lamar, but Lamar, he's even getting more design runs. It's just coming from scrambles. And it is higher variance. It definitely has a high ceiling. But you lose a lot of touchdown equity when you're not running those RPOs constantly by the goal line. And it's just a different fantasy dynamic when you're stripping out so much of that high leverage rushing usage.

ADAM LEVITAN:

Silva, anything sticks out to you about tonight's game or anything for the poly bros on tonight's game?

EVAN SILVA:

Malachi Fields, over 25 yards receiving.

ADAM LEVITAN:

Mm-hmm. He's been earning targets, man.

EVAN SILVA:

Yeah, he's decent. I mean, he's decent. Shout out Notre Dame, of course. Yep. He's big. He's long. He's had some decent yardage games. I think the 25 yards should be very, very doable against the Washington secondary. Malachi Fields plays almost every snap. You know, Giants number two receiver. I mean, everyone knows that, you know, you got to try to slow down Malik neighbors. And Malachi Fields has been J.J. McCarthy's dude a little bit over Isaiah Likely. I know Likely scored the touchdown last week. That was when Jameis Winston went into the game.

ADAM LEVITAN:

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Yeah. Yeah, if you're an Isaiah Likely owner in fantasy football, you want Jameis Winston to find his way onto the field again. Certainly. Certainly. Yeah. And I think for neighbors also, I do think, you know, they're going to try to run the ball and hide

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